

AISH and ADAP: Key Features for Single Clients

Verified and current, July 2026. The transition is in force. This replaces the older “proposed” chart going around.

Feature	AISH before July 2026	AISH now (revised)	ADAP (new program)
Who it is for	Severe disability that substantially limits the ability to earn a living.	Severe disability that permanently prevents employment. Assessed as unable to work.	Severe disability that substantially impedes employment. Assessed as able to work.
How you are assessed	AISH application plus AISH medical report. AISH staff decide.	One combined Disability Assistance application plus a Disability Assistance Medical Report (DAMR). The Medical Review Panel reviews inability to work.	The same combined application. An adjudicator decides work capability.
Maximum monthly benefit (single)	\$1,940	\$1,940	\$1,740. Clients moved from AISH are held at \$1,940 by a \$200 top-up until Dec 31, 2027.
Earnings exemption (single)	\$1,072 per month	\$350 per month	\$700 per month
Above the exemption	50% reduction from \$1,073 to about \$2,009, then 100% above about \$2,010.	100% clawback. Every dollar above \$350 comes off dollar for dollar.	Gradual reduction, rising to full deduction at about \$45,240 in annual income.
Employment supports	Limited. Not employment-focused.	Limited. Not employment-focused.	Individualized supports: assessments, referrals, employment plans, case management. Run by outside contractors, AKG in Edmonton and the north, Serco in Calgary and the south. No employer-side obligations.
Health benefits	Continue while on AISH.	Kept to age 65, even if earnings exceed the threshold.	Kept to age 65, even if earnings exceed the threshold.
Inflation indexing	Automatic annual increase (the legislated Alberta escalator).	No longer automatic. Set by government regulation, and not guaranteed.	No longer automatic. Set by government regulation, and not guaranteed.
Appeals: money and benefits (non-medical)	Citizen's Appeal Panel.	Citizen's Appeal Panel. Covers living allowance, health benefits, child benefit, personal benefits.	Citizen's Appeal Panel. Covers living allowance, health benefits, child benefit, personal benefits.
Appeals: medical eligibility	Appealed through the appeal panel.	An adjudicator's refusal to refer you to the Medical Review Panel can be appealed to the ADAP Medical Appeal Panel. The Review Panel's final AISH decision is not appealable .	A decision that you are not eligible for ADAP can be appealed to the ADAP Medical Appeal Panel.

How medical appeals work

ADAP Medical Appeal Panel (MAP): hears appeals of an adjudicator's decision not to refer you to the AISH Medical Review Panel, and of a decision that you are not eligible for ADAP. Its members are health professionals who are not government employees.

AISH Medical Review Panel (MRP): makes the final AISH eligibility determination, which is not appealable. Reassessment for AISH, with no deadline, is the separate route back.

Citizen's Appeal Panel (CAP): hears non-medical appeals, such as living allowance, health benefits, child benefit and personal benefits.

Compiled from Government of Alberta and Alberta Health Services sources and the AISH General Regulation, current July 2026. Confirm the details that affect you by phone before you count on them.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

St. Albert, Alberta | July 2026 | albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com